

BASIC SIGHT-SINGING AND EAR TRAINING FOR CHURCH SINGERS

PITCH EXERCISES 9.2



INSTRUCTIONS FOR PITCH EXERCISES 9.2

1. If the files linked Slide 4 look familiar, it is because they are the same files you worked with in Form Analysis Exercises 8.1. You should already have print outs of them. If not, download and print them out again.

STAGE 1.

2. In each example, identify the key and determine which note is DO. Then look at the vertical chords formed by the Soprano, Alto, Tenor, and Bass parts. Determine where they are in relation to DO, and label the notes sung by each of the respective voices with the appropriate SOL-FA syllables.
3. Determine which voice has the root, the third, and the fifth in each of the the chords.
4. Do this for each **different** chord in the first set of distinct phrases for the given Tone, that is, Phrases 1 & 2, or Phrases 1, 2, & 3, depending on the structure of the Tone.

THIS CONCLUDES STAGE 1—the “analytic stage”. Go on to STAGE 2.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PITCH EXERCISES 9.2 (CONT'D)

STAGE 2.

5. Starting with the highest note of the first chord, sing the pitches forming the chord from the top down (in your range) or from the bottom up (also in your range).
6. Sing the same chord again, naming each voice part and the note they are singing, for example, Soprano-DO, Alto-SOL, Tenor-MI, Bass-DO. Try to hear the entire chord in relation to the pitches you are singing.
7. Repeat Steps 5 & 6 for each chord that you gave marked in Stage 1, that is, for each different chord that makes up the unique phrases of a given Tone.
8. Do this several times, so that you can begin hearing in your mind's ear the **chord progressions**—the changes in sound that occur as the music progresses from one chord to the next.

LINKS

1. [Troparion Tone 1](#)
2. [Troparion Tone 2](#)
3. [Troparion Tone 3](#)
4. [Troparion - Abbr. Greek Tone 4](#)
5. [Troparion - Moscow Synodal Tone 4](#)
6. [Troparion Tone 5](#)
7. [Troparion Tone 6](#)
8. [Troparion Tone 7](#)
9. [Troparion - Common Tone 8](#)
10. [Troparion - Kievan Caves Tone 8](#)

Congratulations!

You have taken a very important step to developing **harmonic audition**—being able to look at a 4-part chord and being able to hear what it sounds like!

This is a skill that is developed over time with practice. So do not be discouraged, but persevere in your practicing!

Because the “vocabulary” of chords you are likely to encounter in Orthodox church music is limited, eventually you will develop the ability to recognize **and hear** chords as you look at them, and more importantly, hear your part in relation to the others—something that is essential for a good choral singer.